many areas. Several enterprises and combines had to restrict their electric power supply during peak times; in city gas supply systems there were break-downs and failures as well as quality reductions'.6 He stressed the need for more scientists in the production of top-level products. 'This requires engineering economists get together with other specialists and accurately figure the costs of every part of the product, on the basis of world top-level standards.' He demanded higher goals be set in productivity and effectivity, particularly in electronics, the chemical industry and machine-building. 'We need at the same time an uncompromising struggle against smug self-satisfaction, overbearing attitudes, and mediocrity in work, on all levels.'

On one-point Honecker was particularly specific: the complete build-up and remodelling of the centres of Berlin, as well as the downtown sections of Dresden, Gera, Suhl, Jena and Schwedt. In the cultural sphere, he expressed satisfaction with GDR TV which, he said, had captured the hearts and minds of millions of people by producing a series of socialist plays by authors including Bernhard Seeger, Helmut Sakowski, Benito Wogatzki and Karl-Georg Egel.

The achievements of the collectives participating in these television plays have the task of drawing worthy portraits of socialist heroes of our time and have been able to clarify through them – in a surrogate fashion for many people – the revolutionary change in social conditions and in people, here in our German Democratic Republic.

That summer, Honecker was constantly and restlessly on the move. He led a party-government delegation to Moscow, Leningrad and Kyiv, to learn about the work of industrial enterprises, scientific research institutions, metal works, collective farms and cultural workers.